

Nick Abegg

PhD Student, Informatics Security (Privacy), Minor Psychology

Luddy School of Informatics, Indiana University Bloomington

Bloomington, USA

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Sociotechnical interactions of privacy

Privacy of vulnerable or marginalized groups

Psychological privacy

Social science methodologies (surveys, qualitative interviews, ethnography)

EDUCATION

PhD in Informatics Security (Privacy) — *Indiana University Bloomington*

2024 – Present

Advisor: [Dr. Apu Kapadia](#)

Minor in Psychology

GPA: 4.00

BS in Computer Science — *Saint Vincent College*

2020 – 2024

Graduated with honors

Minor in Philosophy

GPA: 3.99

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

NSF Research — *Northumbria University | Citizen-Centered Artificial Intelligence*

May 2026 – July 2026

AI Misinformation & Older Adults

- Conducted qualitative interviews, thematic analysis, and a participatory workshop examining older adults' experiences with AI and misinformation, including contentious intergenerational conversations.

Facial Differences & Facial Recognition Technology – Faces Equality International

- Synthesized interdisciplinary literature with survey and interview data to investigate facial-recognition harms experienced by people with facial differences.
- Reviewed existing harm taxonomies and developed a temporal taxonomy of harms through iterative case studies and design exercises, with implications for disability justice and UK policy.

- **Methods:** Qualitative interviews; thematic analysis; participatory workshops; interdisciplinary literature review; taxonomy development

Research Assistant — *Indiana University Bloomington*

2024 – Present

- Digital Parental Sharing (“Sharenting”) research investigating sentiments and attitudes of Americans on policy and technical interventions to enhance children’s privacy via a 1000-participant representative survey.
- Dyad interviews with parents and children to identify sharenting are conducted, negotiated, and understood
- Collaborative projects with researchers from Indiana University, the University of Washington, and the University of Central Florida
- **Methods:** factor analysis; large-scale survey design; qualitative interviews; thematic analysis
Programming: R, Python
Tools: LaTeX, Qualtrics, NVivo, R Studio, Visual Studio Code

NSF REU — *Pennsylvania State University, Information Science and Technology Department*

May 2023 – Aug 2023

- Machine Learning and Cybersecurity REU advised by [Dr. Dongwon Lee](#)
- Proposed novel designs to automate the task of obscuring the authorship (human vs. LLM) of a given text. Utilized psycho-linguistic information theory
- **Methods:** Natural Language Processing (NLTK), Psycho-linguistic Information Theory
Programming: Python
Tools: LaTeX, Git, Visual Studio Code

Involved Labs

- **Privacy Lab**, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024 – Present
- **C- Lab**, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024 – Present
- **Cultural Computing and Society Lab**, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024 – Present

PUBLICATIONS & WORKING PAPERS

Published Works

- **Nick Abegg**, Ritika Gairola, Christena Nippert-Eng, Apu Kapadia, *Normalizing Harm Through Teenagers’ Everyday Experiences with Video Games*. ACM CHI Play 2026

Preprint

- **Abegg, N.** (2023). *UID as a Guiding Metric for Automated Authorship Obfuscation*. arXiv preprint (cs.CL).
Undergraduate research (REU project).

Working Papers

- **Nick Abegg**, Chris McCarthy, Sabila Nawshin, Mary Jean Amon, Apu Kapadia, *American Preferences for Parental Sharing Interventions: A Representative Survey on Preferences for Parental Sharing (“Sharenting”) Policy and Sociotechnical Interventions in the United States*. **Status:** ACM CHI 2027; Under Review
- Aneka Williams, **Nick Abegg**, Mary Jean Amon, Apu Kapadia, *Dyad Interviews of Parent-Child on Digital Parental Sharing*. **Status:** Manuscript in preparation
- Leigh Levinson, **Nick Abegg**, Christena Nippert-Eng, *In the Spirit of COPPA: An Exploration of the Child Privacy Regulator Landscape in America*. **Status:** Manuscript in preparation

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, CS 110 & CS 111 C++ Programming I & II — *Saint Vincent College, Computer Science Department*
2023 – 2024

- Night lectures. Created supplemental practice material to reinforce course material
- Office hours

Computer Science Head Tutor — *Saint Vincent College, Computer Science Department*
2022 – 2024

- Managed a group of undergrad tutors, developing a schedule, tutoring policy, and coordinating with professors
- Primarily tutored C++ and Data Structures

PRESENTATIONS & TALKS

- Sociotechnical Complexities of Privacy in the Home, Midwest Security Workshop, 2025, Indiana University Bloomington

HONORS & AWARDS

- Distinguished Senior Award – Computer Science Department, Saint Vincent College, 2024
- Summa Cum Laude – Saint Vincent College, 2024
- Alpha Iota Mu, Computer Science Honors Society, Saint Vincent College, 2024

SERVICE & ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

- Treasurer, Graduate Informatics Student Association, Luddy School of Informatics, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024 – Present
- Computing Cultural Society Reading Group, Luddy School of Informatics, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024 – Present
- Computer Science Club President, Saint Vincent College, 2022 – 2024
- Association for Computing Machinery Local Chapter Chairman, Saint Vincent College, 2022 – 2024
- Student Government Association Senator, Saint Vincent College, 2020 – 2024

- System Administrator and Cybersecurity Assistant, Saint Vincent College IT Department, 2022 – 2023

COURSEWORK

- Introduction to HCI
- Human-centered Research Methods
- Direct Observation and Design (Ethnography Methods Course)
- Security for Networked Systems
- Human Factors in Cybersecurity
- Article Writing for PhDs
- Systems and Protocol Security and Information Assurance

- Advance Statistics in Psychology
- Representation of Structure in Psychological Data
- Psychology of Groups and Group Processes